The Two Largest Maritime Oil Trade Chokepoints In The World

Strait of Hormuz

Number of AIS positions reported by oil and gas vessels per grid cell in the Strait of Hormuz region (Jan 2015- Feb 2021)

Value
787156
37099

In 2024, an average of 20.7 million barrels of crude oil were transported through the Strait of Hormuz every day. Compared to a global daily average maritime crude oil transport of 79.7 million barrels, this represents roughly 26% of global maritime crude oil traffic (US Energy Information Administration).

As of the time of the creation of this map (March 2026), due to the ongoing US and Israeli war against Iran, transit through the Strait of Hormuz has been blocked by Iran, which Iran is using as leverage against the US and Israel (PBS).

Number of AIS positions reported by oil and gas vessels per grid cell in the Strait of Malacca region (Jan 2015- Feb 2021)

Value
574755
21562

In 2024, an average of 22.5 million barrels of crude oil were transported through the Strait of Malacca every day. Compared to a global daily average maritime crude oil transport of 79.7 million barrels, this represents roughly 28% of global maritime crude oil traffic (US Energy Information Administration).

83% of China's oil imports transit through the Strait of Malacca (Modern Diplomacy).

Strait of Malacca

0 500 1,000 2,000 Miles

Basemap Source: Earthstar Geographics;
Raster data source: esri_oceans, World Bank, IMF

Map created by Brady Shields; March 15, 2026. This map is a project for Geog370: Cartography at Oregon State University.